TaskFlow Platform — Complete User Manual

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SECTION 1: OVERVIEW

1.1 Introduction to TaskFlow

TaskFlow is a cloud-based Software-as-a-Service (SaaS) platform purpose-built to help businesses, teams, and freelancers plan, organize, execute, and track their work with speed and clarity. Whether you are managing a five-person startup or coordinating across a distributed enterprise with hundreds of employees, TaskFlow provides a unified workspace where every task, project, conversation, and file lives in one place.

At its core, TaskFlow eliminates the chaos of scattered emails, disconnected spreadsheets, and siloed communication tools. It replaces these fragmented workflows with a single, intelligent platform that gives every team member — from the executive sponsor to the freelance contributor — a clear view of what needs to be done, who is responsible for it, and when it is due.

TaskFlow was designed around three fundamental principles:

Clarity: Every task and project has a clear owner, a defined deadline, and a visible status so that nothing falls through the cracks.

Collaboration: Teams communicate directly within the context of their work, reducing unnecessary meetings and back-and-forth emails.

Control: Managers and administrators have the visibility and controls needed to keep projects on track, manage resources, and generate actionable reports.

1.2 Target Users and Business Use Cases

TaskFlow is built for a wide range of users and industries. Below are the primary user groups and how they benefit from the platform.

Small and Medium Businesses (SMBs): SMBs use TaskFlow to bring structure to their operations without the overhead of complex enterprise tools. Teams can quickly set up projects, assign work, and track progress from day one without requiring extensive training or IT support.

Enterprise Teams: Large organizations use TaskFlow to manage cross-functional projects, coordinate between departments, and maintain visibility at the executive level through dashboards and reporting. Role-based access controls ensure that sensitive data is only accessible to the right people.

Freelancers and Independent Contractors: Freelancers use TaskFlow to manage their client deliverables, track billable tasks, and communicate with clients professionally. The freelancer role provides a scoped view of only the projects and tasks they are involved in.

Remote and Distributed Teams: TaskFlow's cloud-native architecture makes it ideal for teams working across different time zones. Asynchronous communication features such as comments, mentions, and file attachments keep work moving even when team members are not online simultaneously.

Creative Agencies: Agencies managing multiple client projects simultaneously use TaskFlow's project dashboards and Gantt charts to monitor timelines, manage client deliverables, and ensure on-time delivery.

Software Development Teams: Development teams use TaskFlow alongside agile methodologies, organizing work into sprints, tracking bugs and features as tasks, and managing releases with milestone tracking.

1.3 Key Benefits of Using TaskFlow

Centralized Work Management: All tasks, projects, files, and communications are stored in one platform, eliminating the need to switch between multiple tools.

Improved Accountability: Every task has a clearly defined assignee and deadline. Managers can see at a glance who is working on what and whether work is on track.

Real-Time Collaboration: Team members can comment on tasks, share files, and mention colleagues directly within the task interface, creating a complete history of every decision and discussion.

Flexible Project Views: Users can view their work in multiple formats including list view, board view, calendar view, and Gantt chart view, allowing each person to work in the format that suits them best.

Powerful Reporting: TaskFlow generates detailed reports on task completion rates, project progress, team performance, and workload distribution, giving leadership the data they need to make informed decisions.

Scalable Permissions System: The role-based access control system ensures that as teams grow and projects become more complex, the right people always have access to the right information.

Integration Ready: TaskFlow integrates with popular third-party tools including Slack, Google Drive, Dropbox, Zoom, GitHub, and more, fitting seamlessly into your existing technology stack.

Mobile and Desktop Access: TaskFlow is accessible via web browsers on desktop and through native mobile applications on iOS and Android, ensuring productivity regardless of location or device.

SECTION 2: KEY FEATURES

2.1 Task Management

Task Management is the foundation of TaskFlow. The platform provides a comprehensive set of tools to create, organize, assign, and track tasks across individuals and teams.

Creating Tasks: Tasks can be created from multiple entry points across the platform: from the main navigation bar, from within a project, from the dashboard quick-action panel, or by using the keyboard shortcut Ctrl+T (Windows) or Cmd+T (Mac). When creating a task, users fill in the task title, description, assignee, due date, priority level, and task type. All fields except the title are optional during creation, allowing tasks to be captured quickly and enriched with details later.

Assigning Tasks: Tasks can be assigned to one or more team members. The assignee receives an automatic notification upon assignment. In cases where a task requires collaboration between multiple people, co-assignees can be added. The primary assignee bears responsibility for the task's completion, while co-assignees are responsible for contributing to it.

Task Priorities: TaskFlow uses a four-tier priority system to help teams focus on what matters most. The priority levels are Urgent, High, Medium, and Low. Priority is displayed visually with color-coded indicators: red for Urgent, orange for High, blue for Medium, and grey for Low. Users can filter and sort their task lists by priority to ensure critical work is addressed first.

Task Statuses: Each task moves through a defined lifecycle represented by statuses. The default statuses are To Do, In Progress, In Review, Blocked, and Done. Administrators and project managers can customize these statuses at the project level to match their specific workflows. For example, a software development project might use statuses such as Backlog, Development, Testing, Staging, and Released.

Due Dates and Time Tracking: Tasks can have a start date and a due date. TaskFlow highlights overdue tasks in red and upcoming deadlines in amber to alert users before tasks become late. Built-in time tracking allows users to log hours spent on each task, providing data for billing, productivity analysis, and resource planning.

Task Dependencies: TaskFlow supports the creation of task dependencies to model real-world workflows where some tasks cannot begin until others are completed. Users can set a task as a predecessor or successor to another task. When a predecessor task is delayed, TaskFlow automatically alerts the owners of dependent tasks so they can adjust their plans accordingly.

Task Categorization: Tasks can be categorized using custom tags and labels. Tags are freeform text identifiers that users create to organize tasks by theme, client, department, or any other relevant category. For example, a marketing team might use tags such as "Q4 Campaign," "Social Media," and "Content" to organize their tasks. Tags make it easy to filter and search for related work across multiple projects.

Sub-Tasks: Complex tasks can be broken down into smaller sub-tasks. Each sub-task is a standalone item with its own assignee, due date, and status. Sub-tasks appear nested beneath the parent task, providing a clear visual hierarchy. The parent task's progress bar updates automatically based on the completion percentage of its sub-tasks.

Recurring Tasks: Tasks that need to be performed on a regular schedule can be set as recurring. Users can configure recurrence patterns including daily, weekly, monthly, and custom intervals. Recurring tasks are automatically generated in advance according to the specified schedule.

2.2 Project Tracking

Managing Multiple Projects: TaskFlow allows users to manage an unlimited number of projects simultaneously. Each project has its own dedicated workspace containing all associated tasks, milestones, files, and communications. Projects can be organized into folders or portfolios for easier navigation.

Gantt Charts: The Gantt chart view provides a visual timeline of all tasks within a project, displayed as horizontal bars against a calendar axis. Users can see task durations, start and end dates, dependencies, and milestone markers at a glance. Tasks can be dragged and dropped on the Gantt chart to reschedule them, and the chart automatically adjusts dependent tasks accordingly.

Project Dashboards: Each project has a dedicated dashboard that displays key metrics including overall completion percentage, number of tasks by status, upcoming deadlines, recent activity, and team workload. Project managers use the dashboard as their primary tool for monitoring project health.

Milestones: Milestones are significant checkpoints within a project, such as the completion of a major deliverable or the end of a project phase. They are displayed prominently on the Gantt chart and project timeline. Approaching milestones trigger automatic alerts to the project manager and relevant team members.

Project Templates: Users can save any project as a template and reuse it for future projects with similar structures. Templates include the project's task structure, milestones, and default assignments, dramatically reducing setup time for recurring project types.

2.3 Collaboration and Communication

In-Task Comments: Every task has a built-in comment thread where team members can discuss work, ask questions, and share updates. Comments are timestamped and attributed to the author, creating a complete audit trail of all discussions related to the task.

@Mentions: Users can mention any team member in a comment using the @ symbol followed by their name. The mentioned user receives an instant notification, ensuring that important messages are never missed. Mentions can also be used to notify entire teams by mentioning a team group name.

Reactions: Team members can react to comments with emoji reactions, providing a quick way to acknowledge messages without adding unnecessary reply comments. Common reactions include thumbs-up for approval, eyes for acknowledgment, and checkmark for confirmation.

Team Inbox: The Team Inbox is a centralized feed that aggregates all comments, mentions, and updates directed at a user. It acts as a single destination for all task-related communications, eliminating the need to visit each task individually to check for updates.

Direct Messaging: In addition to task-level communications, TaskFlow provides a direct messaging feature that allows team members to have one-on-one or group conversations. Direct messages are linked to the platform's notification system, ensuring timely responses.

2.4 Notifications and Alerts

Email Notifications: TaskFlow sends email notifications for key events including task assignments, approaching deadlines, overdue tasks, new comments and mentions, status changes, file uploads, and project updates. Users can customize which events trigger email notifications from their account settings.

In-App Notifications: In-app notifications appear in the notification bell icon in the top navigation bar. They provide real-time alerts without requiring users to leave the platform. The notification badge displays the count of unread notifications.

Deadline Alerts: TaskFlow sends deadline alerts at configurable intervals before a task is due. By default, alerts are sent 48 hours and 24 hours before the deadline. Users and administrators can customize these intervals from notification settings.

Overdue Notifications: When a task passes its due date without being marked as complete, TaskFlow sends an overdue notification to the assignee and the project manager. Overdue tasks are visually highlighted in red across all task views.

Activity Digest: Users can subscribe to a daily or weekly activity digest that summarizes all activity on their assigned tasks and projects. This is useful for users who prefer to review updates in batches rather than receiving individual notifications throughout the day.

2.5 Reporting and Analytics

Project Progress Reports: TaskFlow generates project progress reports that show the percentage of tasks completed, tasks in progress, tasks not started, and overdue tasks. These reports are available in tabular and chart formats and can be filtered by date range, team member, or task type.

Team Performance Reports: Team performance reports provide data on individual and team-level productivity including tasks completed per week, average task completion time, on-time delivery rate, and tasks overdue. Managers use these reports to identify high performers and team members who may need additional support.

Workload Reports: Workload reports show the distribution of tasks across team members, helping managers identify who is overloaded and who has capacity to take on additional work. The workload view displays each team member's current task count and estimated hours.

Custom Reports: Users with manager or admin roles can build custom reports by selecting specific metrics, date ranges, projects, and team members. Custom reports can be saved for repeated use and scheduled for automatic delivery via email to designated recipients.

Visual Analytics: TaskFlow's analytics dashboard presents data through visual charts including bar charts for task volume over time, pie charts for task distribution by status, line charts for productivity trends, and heat maps for workload distribution. All charts are interactive, allowing users to click into specific data points for more detail.

Report Export: Reports can be exported in PDF and CSV formats for sharing with stakeholders who do not have TaskFlow accounts. PDF exports include visual charts and formatted tables, while CSV exports provide raw data suitable for further analysis in spreadsheet applications.

2.6 User Permissions and Roles

TaskFlow uses a role-based access control system with four primary roles: Admin, Manager, Employee, and Freelancer. Each role has a defined set of permissions that determine what actions the user can take and what data they can access. A detailed breakdown of roles and permissions is provided in Section 3.

SECTION 3: USER ROLES AND PERMISSIONS

3.1 Overview of the Role System

TaskFlow's role-based access control system ensures that users have access to the features and data appropriate for their position and responsibilities. Roles are assigned at the organization level by administrators. In addition to organization-level roles, project-level permissions can be configured independently, giving administrators fine-grained control over who can see and do what within each project.

3.2 Admin Role

The Admin role is the highest-privilege role in TaskFlow. Admins have unrestricted access to all platform features, data, and settings.

Admin Permissions Include:

Organization Management: Admins can create, edit, and delete the organization's TaskFlow workspace. They manage billing, subscription plans, and workspace settings.

User Management: Admins can invite new users, assign or change roles, deactivate or delete user accounts, and reset passwords. They can also view all users' activity logs.

Project Management: Admins can create, edit, archive, and delete any project in the workspace. They can assign any team member to any project.

Task Management: Admins have full access to create, edit, assign, reassign, and delete any task across all projects.

Reporting: Admins can access all reports, including organization-wide performance metrics, team workload data, and financial time-tracking reports.

Settings: Admins control all workspace settings including notification preferences, integration configurations, security settings (such as two-factor authentication enforcement), and custom workflow setup.

Role Assignment: Admins are the only role that can assign the Admin role to other users. They can also modify or remove Admin access.

Typical Admin Users: The Admin role is typically assigned to IT administrators, operations leads, platform owners, or founders who need complete control over the workspace.

3.3 Manager Role

The Manager role is designed for team leads, project managers, and department heads who need broad access to manage projects and people within their area of responsibility.

Manager Permissions Include:

Project Creation and Management: Managers can create new projects, edit project details, set timelines, and archive projects they manage. They cannot delete projects (this requires Admin access).

Team Assignment: Managers can add team members to their projects and assign tasks to any member of those projects.

Task Management: Managers can create, edit, assign, reassign, and close any task within their projects. They can also manage task priorities and deadlines.

Reporting: Managers can generate and view reports for their projects and team members. They can export reports but cannot access reports for projects they do not manage.

User Invitations: Managers can invite new users to the workspace and assign them the Employee or Freelancer role. They cannot assign the Admin or Manager role.

Workflow Customization: Managers can customize task statuses and workflows at the project level.

Typical Manager Users: The Manager role is assigned to project managers, team leads, department managers, and senior staff who are responsible for coordinating work across a team.

3.4 Employee Role

The Employee role is designed for regular team members who work on tasks within projects they have been assigned to.

Employee Permissions Include:

Task Management: Employees can create tasks within projects they are members of. They can edit tasks assigned to them, update task statuses, add comments, and upload files. They cannot delete tasks or reassign tasks to other users without manager approval.

Project Visibility: Employees can view all projects they are members of, including the project dashboard, task list, Gantt chart, and team member list. They cannot view projects they have not been added to.

Reporting: Employees can view their own task performance data and basic project progress reports. They cannot access team-wide performance reports or workload data for other employees.

Communication: Employees can comment on tasks, use @mentions, and participate in direct messaging with other team members.

File Management: Employees can upload and download files attached to tasks and projects within their project memberships.

Profile Management: Employees can manage their own profile settings, notification preferences, and UI customizations.

What Employees Cannot Do: Employees cannot create new projects, invite new users, assign roles, access billing settings, view organization-wide reports, or modify workspace settings.

3.5 Freelancer Role

The Freelancer role is the most restricted role, designed for external contributors, contractors, and clients who need limited access to specific tasks and projects.

Freelancer Permissions Include:

Limited Project Access: Freelancers can only see projects they have been explicitly invited to. Unlike employees who can see all projects in their organization, freelancers have a scoped view limited to their assigned work.

Task Visibility: Freelancers can view and update only the tasks specifically assigned to them. They cannot see other team members' tasks or the full task list for a project.

Comments and Communication: Freelancers can comment on tasks assigned to them and use @mentions to communicate with team members on those tasks.

File Uploads: Freelancers can upload files to tasks they are assigned to.

What Freelancers Cannot Do: Freelancers cannot create tasks, create or modify projects, access project reports, view team member lists, invite other users, or access any settings outside of their personal profile.

3.6 Role Comparison Table

Permission	Admin	Manager	Employee	Freelancer
Create Projects	Yes	Yes	No	No
Delete Projects	Yes	No	No	No
Invite Users	Yes	Yes (limited)	No	No
Assign Roles	Yes	Partial	No	No
Create Tasks	Yes	Yes	Yes	No
Edit Any Task	Yes	Yes (own projects)	Own tasks only	No
View All Projects	Yes	Assigned only	Assigned only	Assigned only
Generate Reports	Yes	Yes (own projects)	Own data only	No
Access Billing	Yes	No	No	No
Workspace Settings	Yes	No	No	No
Export Reports	Yes	Yes	No	No

3.7 Assigning and Modifying Roles

Only Admin users can assign roles to other users. To assign or change a role:

Step 1: Navigate to Settings from the main navigation menu. Step 2: Click on User Management under the Organization section. Step 3: Locate the user whose role you wish to assign or change. Step 4: Click the three-dot menu icon next to the user's name. Step 5: Select Change Role from the dropdown menu. Step 6: Choose the appropriate role from the role selection screen. Step 7: Click Save Changes to apply the new role.

The user will receive a notification informing them of their role change. Role changes take effect immediately.

SECTION 4: NAVIGATION AND DASHBOARD

4.1 Overview of the Main Dashboard

Upon logging in, users are directed to the main dashboard, which serves as the home base for all activity in TaskFlow. The dashboard is designed to give users an immediate, at-a-glance view of their most important work without requiring them to navigate to individual projects or task lists.

The dashboard is divided into several key areas:

My Tasks Widget: Displays all tasks assigned to the current user, sorted by due date by default. Users can filter this widget by project, priority, or status. Clicking on any task opens the full task detail panel.

Project Overview Widget: Shows a summary of all active projects the user is a member of, including each project's name, overall completion percentage, and next upcoming deadline.

Activity Feed: A real-time stream of recent activity across all projects the user is involved in, including task status changes, new comments, file uploads, and new task assignments.

Upcoming Deadlines Widget: Highlights tasks and milestones due within the next seven days, sorted chronologically. Tasks that are overdue appear at the top of this list in red.

My Schedule: Displays a mini calendar view showing tasks and milestones scheduled for the current week. Clicking on any day expands to show all tasks due on that date.

Team Activity (Managers and Admins only): Provides a summary of team-wide activity including tasks completed today, tasks overdue, and team members currently active on the platform.

4.2 Main Navigation Menu

The main navigation menu runs along the left side of the screen and provides access to all major sections of the platform. The menu items are as follows:

Home: Returns the user to the main dashboard from anywhere in the platform.

My Tasks: Opens the personal task list showing all tasks assigned to the current user across all projects. This view supports multiple display formats including list, board, and calendar.

Projects: Opens the projects directory showing all projects the user is a member of. Users can switch between grid view and list view. Each project card shows the project name, status, completion percentage, team member avatars, and next deadline.

Teams: Displays the organization's team structure, showing team groups, members, and their current workloads. Managers and admins can create and manage teams from this section.

Calendar: Displays all tasks and milestones across all projects in a monthly, weekly, or daily calendar view. Tasks can be created directly from the calendar by clicking on any date.

Inbox: The centralized messaging and notification hub. Displays all @mentions, comments, task assignments, and direct messages.

Reports: Opens the reporting and analytics section where users can generate, view, and export reports based on their permission level.

Settings: Opens the account and workspace settings panel. The options available in settings vary based on the user's role.

4.3 Customizing the Dashboard

Users can personalize their dashboard to display the information most relevant to them.

Adding and Removing Widgets: Click the Customize Dashboard button in the top-right corner of the dashboard. A widget panel slides open from the right, showing all available widgets. Users can drag widgets onto the dashboard or remove existing ones by clicking the X icon on each widget.

Reordering Widgets: Widgets can be reordered by clicking and dragging them to the desired position on the dashboard.

Filtering the Activity Feed: The activity feed can be filtered by project, team member, or activity type. Click the Filter icon above the feed to apply filters.

Dark and Light Mode: Users can toggle between dark mode and light mode from the Settings menu under Appearance. The selected theme is saved to the user's profile and applied across all devices where they are logged in.

4.4 Quick Actions

The Quick Actions panel is accessible from the top navigation bar via the Plus (+) icon. It provides shortcuts for the most common actions:

- Create New Task
- Create New Project
- Upload a File
- Invite a Team Member
- Start a Direct Message

SECTION 5: PROJECTS MANAGEMENT

5.1 Creating a New Project

To create a new project in TaskFlow, follow these steps:

Step 1: Click the Plus (+) icon in the top navigation bar and select New Project, or navigate to the Projects section and click the Create Project button.

Step 2: Enter the project name. Choose a name that clearly identifies the project for all team members.

Step 3: Add a project description. The description should outline the project's goals, scope, and expected outcomes.

Step 4: Set the project start date and end date.

Step 5: Select a project status. The default status is Active. Other options include Planning, On Hold, and Completed.

Step 6: Choose a project color or icon to visually differentiate it from other projects in the directory.

Step 7: Select a project template if applicable, or choose Blank Project to start from scratch.

Step 8: Add team members to the project by searching for their names or email addresses. Assign each team member a project-level role if needed.

Step 9: Click Create Project to finalize and create the project workspace.

5.2 Viewing and Managing Projects

Project List View: The Projects section displays all projects in a list format by default, showing each project's name, status, manager, team size, completion percentage, and deadline. Projects can be sorted by any column by clicking the column header.

Project Card View: Switching to card view displays each project as a visual card with its color, completion ring, and key details. This view is useful for quickly scanning multiple projects.

Project Detail View: Clicking on any project opens the project detail view, which contains the following tabs:

Overview: The project dashboard showing key metrics, recent activity, and upcoming milestones. Tasks: The full task list for the project with options to switch between list, board, and Gantt views. Files: All files uploaded to the project or its tasks. Members: A list of all team members on the project with their roles and task counts. Settings: Project-level settings including status, timeline, workflow customization, and notification preferences.

5.3 Project Status Tracking

Project Status Indicators: Projects have a status field that reflects the current state of the project. Available statuses are:

Planning: The project is in the planning phase. Work has not yet begun. Active: The project is in progress. On Hold: The project has been paused temporarily. At Risk: The project is in danger

of missing its deadline or has encountered blockers. Completed: All project deliverables have been finished and the project is closed.

Status Updates: Project managers can update the project status at any time from the project Overview tab. Status changes are logged in the project's activity history and all team members are notified.

Project Health Indicators: Alongside the status, TaskFlow displays a project health indicator represented by a colored dot: green for on track, yellow for at risk, and red for off track. The health indicator is calculated automatically based on the ratio of on-time to overdue tasks.

5.4 Assigning Team Members to Projects

Step 1: Open the project and navigate to the Members tab. Step 2: Click the Add Member button. Step 3: Search for the team member by name or email address. Step 4: Select the member from the results and assign them a project role (Viewer, Contributor, or Manager). Step 5: Click Add to Project. The team member will receive a notification that they have been added.

Removing Team Members: To remove a member from a project, navigate to the Members tab, click the three-dot menu next to the member's name, and select Remove from Project. Any tasks assigned to this member within the project will be flagged for reassignment.

5.5 Milestones

Milestones mark critical checkpoints or deliverable completions within a project. They are used to communicate major progress points to stakeholders.

Creating a Milestone: Step 1: Open the project and go to the Tasks or Gantt view. Step 2: Click Add Milestone. Step 3: Enter the milestone name and set the milestone date. Step 4: Optionally, link specific tasks to the milestone to indicate that those tasks must be completed before the milestone is achieved. Step 5: Click Save Milestone.

Milestones appear as diamond markers on the Gantt chart and as highlighted entries on the project timeline. When a milestone date approaches, the project manager receives an automatic alert.

5.6 Best Practices for Project Management in TaskFlow

Break large projects into phases or epics and use milestones to mark phase completions.

Define task dependencies at the start of the project to ensure the Gantt chart accurately reflects the project's critical path.

Assign a single project manager as the primary owner of each project to ensure clear accountability.

Update project status and health indicators weekly so that all stakeholders have an accurate view of progress.

Archive completed projects rather than deleting them to preserve their history for future reference and reporting.

SECTION 6: TASK MANAGEMENT

6.1 Creating a Task

Tasks can be created from multiple locations within TaskFlow. The most direct method is as follows:

Step 1: Click the Plus (+) icon in the top navigation bar and select New Task, or press Ctrl+T (Windows) / Cmd+T (Mac).

Step 2: Enter the task title in the Task Name field. Use a descriptive title that clearly identifies what needs to be done.

Step 3: Add a task description. The description should provide all the context the assignee needs to complete the task, including any requirements, links, or references.

Step 4: Select the project this task belongs to from the Project dropdown.

Step 5: Assign the task to one or more team members using the Assignee field.

Step 6: Set the task priority: Urgent, High, Medium, or Low.

Step 7: Set a due date and, optionally, a start date.

Step 8: Add tags to categorize the task if applicable.

Step 9: Attach any relevant files by clicking the Attachment icon.

Step 10: Click Create Task to save the task. The assignee(s) will receive an automatic notification.

6.2 Task Priorities

TaskFlow's four-level priority system helps teams focus on what matters most.

Urgent: Tasks that require immediate attention and must be completed as soon as possible. Typically reserved for critical bugs, client emergencies, or time-sensitive deliverables. Urgent tasks appear at the top of all task lists and trigger immediate notifications.

High: Important tasks that should be addressed before lower-priority items. High-priority tasks are typically those with near-term deadlines or significant business impact.

Medium: Standard tasks that represent normal workload items. The majority of tasks will have medium priority.

Low: Tasks that are important but not time-sensitive. These should be addressed after urgent, high, and medium tasks are completed.

6.3 Task Statuses

The default task statuses in TaskFlow represent the stages of a task's lifecycle. These statuses can be customized at the project level by managers and admins.

To Do: The task has been created but work has not yet started. **In Progress:** A team member is actively working on the task. **In Review:** The task is complete from the assignee's perspective but is awaiting review or approval. **Blocked:** The task cannot proceed due to an external dependency, missing information, or another issue. A comment should be added to explain the blocker. **Done:** The task is fully complete and approved.

Updating a Task Status: Users can update a task's status by clicking the status badge on any task card or within the task detail panel and selecting the new status from the dropdown.

6.4 Using Task Boards

The task board, also known as the kanban view, displays tasks as cards organized in columns representing task statuses. This view is particularly effective for agile teams and for getting a visual overview of work in progress.

Navigating the Board: Each column on the board represents one task status. Task cards within each column display the task title, assignee avatar, due date, and priority indicator. The number of tasks in each column is shown in the column header.

Moving Tasks: Tasks can be moved between columns by dragging and dropping the task card from one status column to another. This automatically updates the task's status.

Adding Tasks from the Board: Clicking the Plus icon at the bottom of any column creates a new task directly in that status.

Filtering the Board: The board can be filtered by assignee, priority, tag, or due date range. Filters are applied using the filter bar above the board.

6.5 Task Dependencies

Task dependencies establish relationships between tasks that dictate the order in which work must be completed.

Types of Dependencies:

Finish-to-Start: Task B cannot start until Task A is finished. This is the most common dependency type. Start-to-Start: Task B cannot start until Task A has started. Finish-to-Finish: Task B cannot finish until Task A has finished.

Adding a Dependency: Step 1: Open the task detail panel for the task you want to make dependent on another. Step 2: Click Add Dependency in the Dependencies section. Step 3: Search for the predecessor task by name. Step 4: Select the dependency type. Step 5: Click Save.

Dependencies are displayed visually in the Gantt chart as arrows connecting the dependent tasks. When a predecessor task is delayed past its due date, TaskFlow automatically flags the dependent task as at risk.

6.6 Sub-Tasks

Sub-tasks allow users to break a complex task into smaller, manageable pieces.

Creating a Sub-Task: Step 1: Open the parent task's detail panel. Step 2: Scroll to the Sub-Tasks section and click Add Sub-Task. Step 3: Enter the sub-task title, assignee, and due date. Step 4: Click Save.

Sub-tasks appear as a nested checklist within the parent task. Each sub-task has its own status, and the parent task's progress bar updates automatically as sub-tasks are completed. Sub-tasks can be converted into standalone tasks if they grow in scope.

6.7 Task Views

TaskFlow offers multiple views for organizing and displaying tasks. Users can switch between views from the toggle in the top-right corner of any task list.

List View: Displays tasks in a flat or grouped list format. Tasks can be grouped by status, priority, assignee, or project. Columns can be customized to show or hide specific task attributes.

Board View (Kanban): Displays tasks as cards in status columns as described above. Best for visualizing workflow and work in progress.

Calendar View: Displays tasks on a calendar according to their due dates. Users can switch between monthly, weekly, and daily calendar formats. Useful for managing deadlines and scheduling.

Gantt View: Displays tasks as a timeline with start and end dates, dependencies, and milestones. Essential for project planning and tracking.

SECTION 7: COLLABORATION AND COMMUNICATION

7.1 Communicating on Tasks

TaskFlow keeps all task-related communication within the task itself, creating a complete record of every discussion and decision.

Adding a Comment: Step 1: Open any task by clicking on its title. Step 2: Scroll to the Comments section at the bottom of the task detail panel. Step 3: Click in the comment box and type your message. Step 4: Use the formatting toolbar to add bold, italic, bullet points, code blocks, or links. Step 5: Click Post Comment to submit.

Editing and Deleting Comments: Users can edit or delete their own comments by hovering over the comment and clicking the three-dot menu. Admins can delete any comment in the workspace.

7.2 Using @Mentions

@Mentions are used to directly notify specific team members within a comment.

Mentioning a User: Type the @ symbol followed by the team member's name in any comment field. A dropdown list of matching users will appear. Select the correct user from the list to insert the mention. The mentioned user will receive an immediate in-app and email notification directing them to the comment.

Mentioning a Team: You can mention an entire team group by typing @ followed by the team group's name. All members of that team group will receive a notification. This is useful for broadcasting updates to an entire team at once.

7.3 File Attachments in Tasks

Files can be attached directly to tasks to share relevant documents, images, designs, or any other files needed to complete the work.

Attaching a File: Step 1: Open the task and click the Attachment icon in the task detail panel. Step 2: Select files from your local device or choose from files already stored in the project's file repository. Step 3: Optionally add a description or version note to the attachment. Step 4: Click Upload.

Attached files appear in the Attachments section of the task and can be previewed directly within TaskFlow for common file types including images, PDFs, and documents.

7.4 Collaboration Across Teams and Freelancers

Working with Multiple Teams: When a project involves members from multiple departments or teams, TaskFlow's permission and notification systems ensure that each team only sees the work relevant to them. Project managers can create team-specific task lists within a project by using tags or custom groupings.

Collaborating with Freelancers: Freelancers are given scoped access to only their assigned tasks. Project managers communicate with freelancers through task comments and the direct messaging feature. Freelancers can upload deliverables as file attachments and update task statuses when work is complete.

Guest Access: Clients and external stakeholders can be given Guest access to specific projects for review purposes. Guests can view project progress and comment on tasks but cannot create or edit tasks.

Best Practices for Remote Collaboration: Always provide comprehensive task descriptions so remote team members have all the context they need without requiring synchronous meetings. Use @mentions to flag urgent items instead of relying on email. Establish team norms for comment response times and status update frequency.

SECTION 8: FILE SHARING AND ATTACHMENTS

8.1 File Upload and Management

Uploading Files to a Project: Files can be uploaded at the project level through the Files tab in any project. This creates a shared file repository for the project.

Step 1: Open the project and navigate to the Files tab. Step 2: Click the Upload Files button. Step 3: Select files from your device or drag and drop them into the upload area. Step 4: Add folder names or labels to organize the files within the repository. Step 5: Click Upload to complete the process.

Supported File Types: TaskFlow supports all common file types including documents (PDF, DOCX, XLSX, PPTX), images (JPG, PNG, GIF, SVG), videos (MP4, MOV), code files, and compressed archives (ZIP, RAR). Individual file size limit is 250MB. Total storage is determined by the subscription plan.

File Organization: Project files can be organized into folders within the Files tab. Folders can be created, renamed, and deleted by team members with project Contributor or Manager roles.

8.2 File Sharing Permissions

Project-Level File Permissions: By default, all members of a project can view and download all files in the project's file repository. Upload permissions are restricted to Contributors and Managers. File deletion is restricted to the file owner and project Managers.

Task-Level File Permissions: Files attached to specific tasks are only visible to users who have access to that task. For freelancers and guests, this means they can only see files attached to their specific tasks.

Sharing Files Externally: Project Managers and Admins can generate a shareable link for any file in the project repository. This link can be sent to external parties who do not have TaskFlow accounts. Shared links can be set to expire after a specified date and can be revoked at any time.

8.3 Version Control

TaskFlow maintains a version history for all files uploaded to the platform.

How Version Control Works: When a file with the same name as an existing file is uploaded to the same location, TaskFlow automatically saves the new upload as a new version rather than replacing the original. The version history panel shows all versions of a file with the upload date, uploader name, and a version number.

Viewing Version History: Step 1: Navigate to the Files tab or the task's attachment section. Step 2: Click on the file name to open the file detail panel. Step 3: Click Version History to see all versions. Step 4: Click on any version to preview or download that specific version.

Restoring a Previous Version: Users with Manager or Admin roles can restore a previous version of a file, which sets that version as the current version while retaining all version history.

SECTION 9: NOTIFICATIONS AND ALERTS

9.1 Types of Notifications

TaskFlow delivers notifications through two primary channels: email and in-app.

In-App Notifications: In-app notifications appear in the notification bell icon in the top navigation bar. They are delivered in real time and include notifications for:

- Task assigned to you
- Task due date approaching (customizable intervals)
- Task overdue
- New comment on a task you are following
- @mention in a comment
- Task status changed on a task you are following
- New file uploaded to a task you are following
- Project status changed
- New team member added to a project you manage

Email Notifications: Email notifications are sent to the user's registered email address. By default, email notifications are sent for task assignments, @mentions, overdue tasks, and daily digest summaries. Users can customize which events trigger email notifications.

Push Notifications: Users who have installed the TaskFlow mobile application can receive push notifications on their mobile devices for all notification types.

9.2 Configuring Notification Preferences

Accessing Notification Settings: Step 1: Click on your avatar or profile picture in the top-right corner of the navigation bar. Step 2: Select Settings from the dropdown menu. Step 3: Navigate to the Notifications tab.

Notification Settings Options: The notifications settings page presents each notification event type with toggle switches for in-app, email, and push notification channels. Users can enable or disable each channel for each event type independently.

For example, a user might enable in-app notifications for all events but restrict email notifications to only task assignments and @mentions to reduce inbox clutter.

Notification Frequency: For events that can generate high volumes of notifications (such as task status changes), users can choose between immediate notifications, hourly digest, or daily digest to control the frequency.

Muting Projects: Users can mute notifications for specific projects by navigating to that project's Settings tab and toggling the Mute Notifications option. When a project is muted, the user will still see activity in their feed but will not receive email or push notifications for that project.

9.3 Activity Logs

Personal Activity Log: Each user has a personal activity log that records every action they have taken in the platform including tasks created, tasks completed, comments posted, files uploaded, and settings changed. The personal activity log is accessible from the user's profile page.

Project Activity Log: Each project has a project-level activity log that records all activity within that project. This includes task creation, status changes, comment activity, file uploads, member changes, and settings modifications. The project activity log is accessible from the project Overview tab.

Organization Activity Log (Admin Only): Admins can access an organization-wide activity log from the Settings panel. This log records all activity across the entire workspace including user logins, role changes, billing updates, and all project activity.

SECTION 10: REPORTING AND ANALYTICS

10.1 Accessing Reports

The Reports section is accessible from the main navigation menu. The reports available to a user depend on their role. Admins see all reports, managers see reports for their projects and teams, and employees see only their personal performance data.

10.2 Project Progress Reports

Description: The project progress report provides a comprehensive snapshot of a project's current state, including task completion rates, tasks by status, overdue tasks, upcoming milestones, and team member contributions.

Generating a Project Progress Report: Step 1: Navigate to the Reports section in the main navigation menu. Step 2: Click New Report and select Project Progress Report. Step 3: Choose the project(s) to include in the report. Step 4: Set the date range for the report. Step 5: Choose the desired output format: table view, chart view, or combined. Step 6: Click Generate Report.

The report will display the following data: total tasks, completed tasks, completion percentage, tasks by status (pie chart), tasks overdue, tasks due this week, milestone status, and a breakdown of task completion by team member.

10.3 Team Performance Reports

Description: Team performance reports analyze individual and collective productivity metrics across a specified time period.

Metrics Included:

- Tasks completed per team member
- Average task completion time per team member
- On-time delivery rate per team member
- Tasks overdue per team member
- Total hours logged per team member
- Comparison to previous period (growth or decline indicators)

Generating a Team Performance Report: Step 1: In the Reports section, click New Report and select Team Performance Report. Step 2: Select the team or individual team members to include. Step 3: Set the time period. Step 4: Click Generate Report.

The report can be displayed as a leaderboard table, individual cards, or a bar chart comparing team members.

10.4 Workload Reports

Description: Workload reports show how work is distributed across team members, helping managers identify capacity issues before they become problems.

Data Shown:

- Current task count per team member
- Estimated hours remaining per team member
- Tasks by priority for each team member
- Overloaded vs. under-utilized team members (flagged automatically)

This report helps managers redistribute work to prevent burnout and ensure balanced workloads.

10.5 Custom Reports

Users with Manager or Admin roles can build custom reports tailored to their specific needs.

Creating a Custom Report: Step 1: In Reports, click New Report and select Custom Report. Step 2: Use the report builder to select the metrics you want to include. Available metrics span tasks, projects, team members, and time periods. Step 3: Apply filters to narrow the data. For example, filter by specific project, team, date range, task type, or priority level. Step 4: Choose the visual format: table, bar chart, pie chart, or line chart. Step 5: Give the report a name and click Save and Generate.

Scheduling Reports: Custom reports can be scheduled for automatic generation and email delivery. Set the delivery frequency (daily, weekly, or monthly), select the recipients, and click Schedule Report.

10.6 Exporting Reports

All reports in TaskFlow can be exported in the following formats:

PDF Export: Generates a formatted PDF document containing the report's visual charts and data tables. The PDF includes the TaskFlow logo, report name, date range, and generation timestamp. Suitable for sharing with stakeholders who need a polished, print-ready format.

CSV Export: Exports the raw data in comma-separated values format. CSV exports are intended for users who need to perform further analysis in Excel, Google Sheets, or other data analysis tools.

Sharing Reports: Reports can be shared internally with other TaskFlow users by selecting Share Report and choosing recipients from the team directory. Recipients receive a notification with a link to view the report within the platform.

SECTION 11: ACCOUNT AND SETTINGS

11.1 Managing Your Profile

Accessing Profile Settings: Click on your avatar in the top-right navigation bar and select Profile to open the profile settings page.

Profile Information: Users can update the following profile details:

- Profile photo or avatar
- Full name
- Job title and department
- Contact email address
- Phone number (optional)
- Bio or short description

Changes to profile information are saved automatically.

Changing Your Password: Step 1: Go to Settings and navigate to the Security tab. Step 2: Click Change Password. Step 3: Enter your current password for verification. Step 4: Enter your new password and confirm it. Step 5: Click Save Password.

Passwords must be at least 12 characters long and include at least one uppercase letter, one lowercase letter, one number, and one special character.

Setting Up Two-Factor Authentication: Step 1: Navigate to Settings and click the Security tab. Step 2: Click Enable Two-Factor Authentication. Step 3: Scan the QR code displayed with your authenticator app (such as Google Authenticator or Authy). Step 4: Enter the six-digit code from the authenticator app to verify the setup. Step 5: Save your recovery codes in a secure location.

Two-factor authentication adds a significant layer of security to your account by requiring a second verification step during login.

11.2 Notification Preferences

Notification preferences can be configured from the Notifications tab in Settings. Refer to Section 9.2 for detailed instructions on configuring notification preferences.

11.3 UI Customization

Theme: Users can choose between Light Mode and Dark Mode from the Appearance section in Settings. A system default option is also available, which automatically matches the theme to the user's operating system setting.

Language: TaskFlow supports multiple languages. Users can change their display language from Settings by navigating to Preferences and selecting their desired language from the Language dropdown. The platform currently supports English, Spanish, French, German, Portuguese, Arabic, Japanese, and Chinese (Simplified).

Date and Time Format: Users can set their preferred date format (MM/DD/YYYY or DD/MM/YYYY) and time format (12-hour or 24-hour) from the Preferences section.

Time Zone: The time zone setting affects how due dates and timestamps are displayed for the user. Setting the correct time zone ensures that deadline notifications are sent at the correct local times.

11.4 Admin Settings

Admin settings are accessible from the Settings panel and are only visible to users with the Admin role.

User Management: Admins can view all users in the organization, invite new users, assign or change roles, deactivate accounts, and delete users. Deactivating an account prevents login but preserves the user's data and task history. Deleting an account permanently removes the user's data.

Organization Settings: Admins can update the organization name, logo, and billing email address. They can also configure the organization's default language and time zone.

Security Settings: Admins can enforce security policies including mandatory two-factor authentication for all users, session timeout duration, allowed IP address ranges for platform access, and single sign-on (SSO) configuration for enterprise customers.

Integration Management: Admins can connect TaskFlow to third-party tools from the Integrations section in Settings. Available integrations include Slack, Microsoft Teams, Google Workspace, Dropbox, GitHub, Jira, Zoom, and Zapier. Each integration has its own configuration guide accessible from the integration's settings panel.

Billing and Subscription: Admins can view and manage the organization's subscription plan, billing history, and payment methods from the Billing section in Settings. Available plans are displayed on the Billing page with a comparison of features for each tier.

Audit Logs: Admins have access to a complete audit log of all user actions across the workspace. The audit log is accessible from Security Settings and can be filtered by user, action type, and date range. Audit logs can be exported in CSV format for compliance and security review purposes.

SECTION 12: SUPPORT AND RESOURCES

12.1 In-Platform Help Center

TaskFlow's built-in Help Center is accessible by clicking the Help icon (question mark) in the bottom-left corner of the navigation bar. The Help Center contains:

Search Functionality: Users can search for help articles by keyword. The search bar returns relevant articles from the knowledge base, ranked by relevance.

Getting Started Guides: Step-by-step guides designed to help new users set up their accounts, create their first project, and invite team members within the first session.

Feature Documentation: Detailed articles covering every feature in the platform, with screenshots and step-by-step instructions.

Video Tutorials: A library of video walkthroughs covering common workflows. Videos range from two to ten minutes in length and cover topics including task creation, project setup, Gantt chart navigation, and report generation.

What's New: A changelog section documenting new features, improvements, and bug fixes in each platform update. Subscribe to the changelog to receive email notifications when new features are released.

12.2 Contacting Customer Support

Live Chat: Live chat support is available for all plan tiers during business hours (Monday to Friday, 9 AM to 6 PM EST). Enterprise plan customers have access to 24/7 live chat support. Access live chat by clicking the Chat Support button in the Help Center.

Email Support: Users can submit a support ticket via email at support@taskflow.com. The standard response time for email support is one business day. Enterprise customers receive a four-hour response time guarantee.

Priority Support (Enterprise): Enterprise plan customers are assigned a dedicated Customer Success Manager who provides onboarding assistance, ongoing training, and direct support via a private communication channel.

Community Forum: The TaskFlow Community Forum is an online space where users can ask questions, share best practices, and connect with other TaskFlow users. The forum is moderated by the TaskFlow support team, and questions are typically answered within 24 hours. Access the forum from the Help Center by clicking Community Forum.

12.3 Knowledge Base

The TaskFlow Knowledge Base is a comprehensive library of articles, tutorials, and FAQs organized by topic. Categories include:

- Getting Started
- Account and Profile Management
- Task Management
- Project Management
- Collaboration Features
- Reporting and Analytics
- Integrations
- Billing and Subscriptions
- Security and Privacy
- Mobile App

The knowledge base is updated with each platform release to document new features and improvements.

12.4 Troubleshooting Common Issues

Cannot Log In: Verify that you are using the correct email address and password. If you have forgotten your password, click the Forgot Password link on the login page to receive a password reset email. Ensure that two-factor authentication is correctly configured if it is enabled on your account.

Notifications Not Arriving: Check that notifications are enabled for the relevant events in your notification preferences. For email notifications, check your spam or junk folder. Ensure that emails from taskflow.com are added to your email allowlist.

Tasks Not Appearing: If you cannot see tasks that you expect to see, verify that you are a member of the project containing those tasks. Check the active filters on your task view, as an active filter may be hiding the tasks.

File Upload Failing: Verify that the file size does not exceed 250MB. Check that your current internet connection is stable. If the file is a type that is not supported by TaskFlow, convert it to a supported format before uploading.

Integration Not Working: If a third-party integration is not functioning correctly, navigate to Settings and open the Integrations panel. Disconnect and reconnect the integration by re-authorizing it. If the issue persists, consult the integration-specific troubleshooting guide in the knowledge base.

Performance Issues: If the platform is loading slowly, try clearing your browser's cache and cookies, then refreshing the page. Ensure you are using a supported browser (latest versions of Chrome, Firefox, Edge, or Safari). If performance issues persist across multiple sessions, contact customer support.

12.5 System Requirements and Supported Platforms

Web Application: TaskFlow's web application is supported on the latest two versions of Google Chrome, Mozilla Firefox, Microsoft Edge, and Apple Safari. Internet Explorer is not supported.

Mobile Application: TaskFlow is available on iOS (iPhone and iPad running iOS 14 or later) and Android (devices running Android 9.0 or later). Download the app from the Apple App Store or Google Play Store.

Internet Connection: TaskFlow requires an active internet connection. A minimum connection speed of 5 Mbps is recommended for optimal performance.

APPENDIX A: GLOSSARY OF TERMS

Assignee: The team member responsible for completing a task.

Blocker: An obstacle preventing a task from progressing.

Dependency: A relationship between tasks that determines the order in which they must be completed.

Gantt Chart: A visual timeline showing tasks, durations, and dependencies.

Kanban: A task management methodology that visualizes work as cards moving through status columns.

Milestone: A significant checkpoint or deliverable completion point within a project.

RAG: Retrieval-Augmented Generation, a technique for enhancing AI responses with relevant retrieved documents.

Role: A predefined set of permissions assigned to a user that determines their access within the platform.

Sub-Task: A smaller task nested within a parent task, representing a component of the larger work item.

Tag: A keyword label used to categorize and filter tasks.

Two-Factor Authentication (2FA): A security method requiring two forms of verification before granting account access.

Webhook: An automated HTTP callback triggered by events in TaskFlow, used to connect with external systems.

Workflow: A defined sequence of task statuses representing the stages of a business process.

APPENDIX B: KEYBOARD SHORTCUTS

Action	Windows / Linux	Mac
Create New Task	Ctrl + T	Cmd + T
Create New Project	Ctrl + Shift + P	Cmd + Shift + P
Open Search	Ctrl + K	Cmd + K
Go to Dashboard	Ctrl + H	Cmd + H

Go to My Tasks	Ctrl + M	Cmd + M
Open Notifications	Ctrl + N	Cmd + N
Save Changes	Ctrl + S	Cmd + S
Close Panel	Escape	Escape
Mark Task Done	Ctrl + Enter	Cmd + Enter

End of TaskFlow Platform User Manual

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That is the complete document in full — all 12 sections, both appendices, every table, every step-by-step guide, nothing omitted. You can now copy this entire text.